

D339

Technical Communication

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

An operations analyst is writing a report that compares three vendors' prices and delivery times so leaders can see the facts. She has been told not to recommend a vendor. The report will be saved in the shared drive's Q3 folder. What type of document is this?

- A. A research proposal.
- B. An archival record, since it is stored in the Q3 folder.
- C. Persuasive.
- D. Informational.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A support manager must tell a customer that a requested refund is denied under company policy. The customer has bought from the company for eight years and pays for the premium tier. Which organization best fits the message?

- A. Indirect: a neutral opening, the reasons, the decision, then an alternative or goodwill close.
- B. Direct: open with the denial in the first sentence.
- C. State the denial and leave out the reasons to keep it short.
- D. Grant the refund anyway because the customer is premium.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which message should use the direct approach, with the main point first?

- A. Rejecting a job applicant.
- B. Confirming to a client that the order shipped today.
- C. Announcing layoffs to staff.
- D. Telling a vendor its contract will not be renewed.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

Edit this sentence for concision: At this point in time, we are in the process of conducting a review of the policy due to the fact that there were complaints. It appears in a memo to 60 staff on the company intranet. Which revision is best?

- A. At this point in time, we are in the process of reviewing the policy for all 60 staff due to complaints.
- B. We are reviewing the policy because of complaints.
- C. Currently, at this time, we are reviewing the policy because of complaints.
- D. Policy. Complaints. Review.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A technical writer drafts a bulleted list for a 14-page new-hire guide that uses the company's green template: Log in to the portal / The timesheet should be opened / Entering your hours. Which revision fixes the list?

- A. Combine the steps into one long paragraph.
- B. Shorten the guide to fewer than 14 pages.
- C. Logging in to the portal / Open the timesheet / Enter your hours
- D. Log in to the portal / Open the timesheet / Enter your hours

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which list is NOT parallel?

- A. Reducing costs, improving quality, and speeding delivery.
- B. Reduce costs, improve quality, and speed delivery.
- C. Reduce costs, improving quality, and faster delivery.
- D. Lower costs, higher quality, and faster delivery.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A project coordinator receives an email sent to 85 people across four departments asking each person to confirm attendance at a training. The email has a colorful banner and was sent at 7:05 a.m. How should she confirm?

- A. Forward the email with her confirmation to her own team.
- B. Reply only to the sender.
- C. Wait until the afternoon, since early-morning emails are informal.
- D. Reply all so everyone knows she is attending.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A manager needs to email 40 external clients about a schedule change without revealing their addresses to one another. Where should the clients' addresses go?

- A. BCC.
- B. To.
- C. CC.
- D. Send 40 separate emails that all require read receipts.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A presenter's slide on quarterly results holds 14 lines of 12-point text. The talk is in a 200-seat auditorium, and the deck uses the corporate font. Which redesign is best?

- A. Use one headline message with a simple chart and a few words; put details in a handout.
- B. Switch to a different font.
- C. Shrink the font to fit even more detail.
- D. Keep all the text and read it aloud.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Readers of a 12-page policy document complain they cannot find anything. Which change most improves scannability?

- A. Remove white space so it fits on fewer pages.
- B. Add more background detail to each section.
- C. Add descriptive headings, short sections, and bulleted lists.
- D. Bold every sentence to show importance.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

An IT lead wants leaders to fund a \$90,000 system upgrade. Her draft memo lists the upgrade's features. The CIO prefers short memos, and the budget meeting is in the executive suite. What most strengthens the persuasive case?

- A.** State that the upgrade is absolutely required, without evidence.
- B.** Cut the memo to one sentence because the CIO likes short memos.
- C.** Add more technical features.
- D.** Define the business problem and show evidence of benefits, such as cost savings or reduced risk.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

An analyst presents findings to 25 managers. She reads each slide word for word while facing the screen. Her deck uses a clean template and was reviewed by the legal team. Which change best improves her delivery?

- A.** Add more words to the slides so she can read them more easily.
- B.** Speak faster to cover more material.
- C.** Rehearse so she can face the audience, make eye contact, and use slides as cues.
- D.** Send the deck to legal for another review.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

An operations analyst is writing a report that compares three vendors' prices and delivery times so leaders can see the facts. She has been told not to recommend a vendor. ~~The report will be saved in the shared drive's Q3 folder.~~ What type of document is this?

Target word: document type **Decides:** Presents facts with no recommendation.

A	Adjacent category	A proposal asks approval for future research; this reports existing facts.
B	Camouflage	Storage location does not decide type.
C	Confusion set	No recommendation or argument is made.
D	Correct	It presents facts for readers to use without arguing for a choice.

2. Answer A Concept 2

A support manager must tell a customer that a requested refund is denied under company policy. ~~The customer has bought from the company for eight years and pays for the premium tier.~~ Which organization best fits the message?

Target word: message organization **Decides:** This is a refusal: bad news.

A	Correct	Bad news is received better when reasons come before the decision.
B	Inverted operation	Direct order is for routine or good news.
C	Dropped element	Drops the explanation readers need to accept the decision.
D	Camouflage	Tier and history do not change the policy decision.

3. Answer B Concept 2 • transfer

Which message should use the direct approach, with the main point first?

Target word: pick the direct-order message — reverse **Decides:** Routine or good news.

A	Inverted operation	Bad news usually uses the indirect approach.
B	Correct	Good, routine news goes first.
C	Confusion set	Sensitive bad news; indirect approach.
D	Adjacent category	A refusal; indirect approach.

4. Answer B Concept 3

Edit this sentence for concision: At this point in time, we are in the process of conducting a review of the policy due to the fact that there were complaints. ~~It appears in a memo to 60 staff on the company intranet.~~ Which revision is best?

Target word: most concise accurate revision **Decides:** Remove filler without losing meaning.

A	Camouflage	Adds the audience size and keeps the filler.
B	Correct	Keeps the meaning in far fewer words.
C	Adjacent category	Replaces filler with a redundancy.
D	Dropped element	Cuts so much the meaning is lost.

5. Answer D Concept 4

A technical writer drafts a bulleted list for a 14-page new hire guide that uses the company's green template: Log in to the portal / The timesheet should be opened / Entering your hours. Which revision fixes the list?

Target word: parallel list **Decides:** All items need the same form.

A	Adjacent category	Removes the list instead of fixing it and hurts scanning.
B	Camouflage	Guide length does not decide list structure.
C	Dropped element	Fixes two items but leaves one in a different form.
D	Correct	All three begin with a command verb.

6. Answer C Concept 4 • transfer

Which list is NOT parallel?

Target word: spot the non-parallel list — reverse **Decides:** Mixed grammatical forms.

A	Confusion set	All -ing forms: parallel.
B	Inverted operation	All verbs: parallel.
C	Correct	Mixes a verb, an -ing word, and a noun phrase.
D	Adjacent category	All adjective-noun phrases: parallel.

7. Answer B Concept 5

A project coordinator receives an email sent to 85 people across four departments asking each person to confirm attendance at a training. ~~The email has a colorful banner and was sent at 7:05 a.m.~~ How should she confirm?

Target word: correct reply method **Decides:** Only the sender needs her answer.

A	Adjacent category	The organizer still has not received her reply.
B	Correct	The other 84 people do not need her confirmation.
C	Camouflage	Send time does not decide how to reply.
D	Confusion set	Floods 84 inboxes with a message meant for one person.

8. Answer A Concept 5 • transfer

A manager needs to email 40 external clients about a schedule change without revealing their addresses to one another. Where should the clients' addresses go?

Target word: correct address field **Decides:** Hide recipients from each other.

A	Correct	Blind copy hides recipients from one another.
B	Dropped element	Drops the privacy need; all addresses are visible.
C	Confusion set	CC shows all addresses to everyone.
D	Adjacent category	Works but is slow and read receipts add friction; BCC is the standard tool.

9. Answer A Concept 6

A presenter's slide on quarterly results holds 14 lines of 12-point text. The talk is in a 200-seat auditorium, ~~and the deck uses the corporate font~~. Which redesign is best?

Target word: best slide redesign **Decides:** Too much small text for a large room.

A	Correct	Readable from the back and focused on the key point.
B	Camouflage	The font is not the problem; volume of text is.
C	Inverted operation	Makes readability worse.
D	Adjacent category	Reading does not fix a crowded slide.

10. Answer C Concept 6 • transfer

Readers of a 12-page policy document complain they cannot find anything. Which change most improves scannability?

Target word: document design fix **Decides:** Readers need navigation cues.

A	Inverted operation	Dense text is harder to scan.
B	Adjacent category	More content does not help readers find things.
C	Correct	These help readers scan and locate content.
D	Absolute language	If everything is emphasized, nothing stands out.

11. Answer D Concept 7

An IT lead wants leaders to fund a \$90,000 system upgrade. Her draft memo lists the upgrade's features. ~~The CIO prefers short memos, and the budget meeting is in the executive suite~~. What most strengthens the persuasive case?

Target word: strongest persuasive fix **Decides:** Decision-makers need the problem and evidence of benefits.

A	Absolute language	An unsupported claim does not persuade.
B	Camouflage	Length preference does not replace evidence.
C	Adjacent category	Features are not benefits the audience cares about.
D	Correct	Ties the request to the audience's goals with evidence.

12. Answer C Concept 8

An analyst presents findings to 25 managers. She reads each slide word for word while facing the screen. ~~Her deck uses a clean template and was reviewed by the legal team~~. Which change best improves her delivery?

Target word: delivery fix **Decides:** Reading slides with her back to the audience.

A	Inverted operation	Deepens the reading problem.
B	Adjacent category	Pace is not the problem.
C	Correct	Connects with the audience and uses slides as support.
D	Camouflage	Legal review does not affect delivery.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	11	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	6	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	2	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Informational vs. persuasive documents	Informational documents present facts for the reader to use; persuasive documents argue for a specific action or belief.	Classifying a document by where it is stored or who reads it.	Whether the writer recommends anything.
2	Direct vs. indirect approach	Routine and good-news messages state the main point first; bad-news messages usually buffer, explain reasons, then give the decision and an alternative.	Opening every message with the bottom line, including a refusal.	Good or routine news vs. a denial or refusal.
3	Concise editing	Cut filler phrases and redundancies so every word carries meaning.	Cutting so much the meaning is lost, or swapping one filler for another.	"At this point in time," "due to the fact that."
4	Parallel structure	Items in a list or series use the same grammatical form.	Fixing only one item, or thinking parallel means the same verb.	Bulleted steps or a series mixing verbs, -ing words, and clauses.
5	Digital etiquette	Reply only to people who need your response, use BCC to protect external addresses, and keep tone professional.	Reply-all to large lists or CC on external mass emails.	A large distribution list or external recipients.
6	Visual design for readers	Use headings, white space, short chunks, and minimal slide text so readers can scan.	Adding more text or shrinking the font to fit more.	Readers can't find information or slides are text-heavy.
7	Building a persuasive case	Define the audience's problem, then support the recommendation with evidence of benefits tied to the audience's goals.	Listing features or asserting necessity without evidence.	A funding request aimed at decision-makers.
8	Presentation delivery	Know the content, face the audience, make eye contact, and use slides as cues rather than a script.	Reading slides word for word or adding text to read from.	A presenter reading with her back to the audience.

Course scope (public description): Technical Communication introduces skills in editing professional communications, evaluating the impact of professional etiquette in digital environments, and in creating artifacts that are persuasive, informational, and research-based. The course also introduces skills in delivering multimedia presentations using professional verbal communication skills.